TITLE: "EXPLORING THE IMPACT OF MARTIAL ARTS ON LEADERSHIP, DISCIPLINE, ETHICAL MINDSET AND WORK ETHICS OF CRIMINOLOGY STUDENTS IN THEIR FUTURE PROFESSION"

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

In the field of criminology, college students are not only trained to understand the law but also to live by the values of honesty, responsibility, and professionalism that are needed in law enforcement and public service. As future defenders of justice and peace, they must develop traits such as courage, self-control, fairness, and good moral judgment. These values help criminology students act with integrity and make ethical decisions, especially when they are placed in situations that test their character. One effective way to develop these important qualities is through martial arts training, which strengthens not only the body but also the mind and moral behavior.

Martial arts is more than just learning how to protect yourself. It's a way of discipline that teaches respect, patience, hard work, and self-awareness. With regular practice, students learn how to control their emotions, stay calm under pressure, and make good decisions even in difficult situations. Research shows that martial arts training helps people become more focused, disciplined, and respectful toward others. It also promotes teamwork, humility, and a strong sense of responsibility. These lessons go beyond physical training—they help shape a person's character, behavior, and attitude in everyday life.

For criminology students, martial arts can serve as a valuable tool for personal and professional growth. It teaches them how to handle challenges with discipline, think critically, and

act fairly in situations involving conflict or stress. The respect for rules, authority, and others that martial arts promote fits perfectly with the ethical standards expected from those in law enforcement and public safety. The values of discipline, humility, and integrity learned through martial arts are the same values needed to serve and protect others. By combining academic knowledge in criminology with the moral and physical discipline of martial arts, students can become more responsible, ethical, and effective professionals who embody justice and compassion in their future careers.

Furthermore, leadership and work ethics play a major role in shaping the character and professionalism of a criminology student. A leadership approach grounded in justice and accountability, whilst a strong work ethic reflects determination, duty, and diligence. When this is combined with ethical thinking grounded in sound judgment and concern, it inspires a terrific and truthful law enforcement officer. According to Bickford (2020), martial arts leadership emphasizes cultural consciousness and strength of will, both of which can be vital in the observe of criminology. Moreover, Kim et al., (2021) noted that Taekwondo training strengthens management, obedience to authority, and emotional control, consistent with the ethical requirements expected in regulatory enforcement professions. This is supported by Harris (2021), who emphasized that martial arts training promotes intellectual fitness and emotional balance in students, thereby improving their personal development and social interaction. Additionally, Oliveira & Vieira (2023) explained that ethical awareness and leadership cannot be separated from professional education because both are developed through continuous moral discipline. A study by Pepperdine University (2020) found that martial artists with black belts demonstrate stronger leadership, greater responsibility, and greater ethical awareness than those without black belts.

Wang (2024) found that coaching in martial arts can foster moral values and motivation toward fulfillment, both of which can be critical for preserving professionalism and moral behavior across diverse fields. This indicates that martial arts training not only enhances physical competence but also instills a deeper sense of space, perseverance, and integrity—qualities essential in professions that require moral obligation. In the context of criminology, these attributes are especially significant, as law enforcers and justice advocates are expected to guide with equity, uphold moral principles, and fulfill their obligations with unwavering dedication. Therefore, exploring the impact of martial arts on leadership, discipline, ethical mindset, and works ethics of criminology students provides valuable insights into how such schooling can make a contribution to shaping in a position, disciplined and morally grounded experts in their future careers.

According to Zhang (2024), joining a martial arts program allows college students to enhance their awareness, behavior, and skills. In the same vein, Yu et al. (2024) stated that martial arts education encourages goal-setting and emotional management, enabling students to handle stress and challenges better. These talents are crucial for criminology students because their future careers require fieldwork, management, and strong moral character. By learning martial arts, they can develop better self-control, responsibility, and moral ethics, enabling them to perform their duties with integrity and professionalism.

In the area of professional development, Butler et al. (2023) found that police trainees skilled in martial arts demonstrated higher emotional stability, self-assurance, and task performance. Likewise, Zhao et al. (2025) confirmed that Wushu training enables college students to increase flexibility, social responsibility, and self-confidence. These findings show that martial arts training not only improves physical fitness but also builds essential personal qualities, including discipline, respect, and strength of mind. For criminology students, these developments

are crucial in growing leadership, moral decision-making, and strong work ethics. By engaging in martial arts, future criminologists can become better prepared to handle stress, lead others effectively, and carry out their duties with honesty and professionalism in their future careers.

In the Philippine context, several studies highlight the significant impact of martial arts on academic development. Research by New Era University (2020) found that coaching self-protection fosters self-confidence and a sense of obligation. Similarly, Baluga (2020) and Favorito & Magtibay (2023) found that martial arts programs strengthen community, professionalism, and effective conduct among students. Supporting this, Mortejo (2025) found that Arnis education enhances cooperation, discipline, and adaptability. These findings support the idea that martial arts play an important role in shaping leadership traits, moral values, and a strong work ethic, key factors in preparing individuals for future professional responsibilities.

In addition, research through WHSC (2023) and MSEUF (2024) has proven that participation in martial arts fosters respect, moral consciousness, and professionalism in the field of criminology. In sum, current research shows that martial arts contribute to the overall shaping of personality by strengthening areas such as management and moral values. Based on this basis, the purpose of the existing have a look at is to explore the impact of martial arts on leadership, discipline, ethical mindset, and work ethics of criminology students at Saint Michael College of Caraga, focusing on how martial arts schooling develops the quality of morality and motivation toward their professional function.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Martial arts are recognized as a discipline that strengthens physical ability, self-control, and moral development. Harwood-Gross et al. (2021) emphasized that continuous participation

in martial arts improves students' emotional control, mental discipline, and social responsibility. These qualities are important in forming responsible and respectful individuals who can manage challenges with patience. Likewise, Bickford (2020) explained that martial arts training develops leadership, accountability, and respect — values that align with the goal of education to produce disciplined and effective professionals. This means that martial arts can be an important training ground for shaping responsible and ethical behavior among students.

Harris (2021) found that martial arts help develop patience, confidence, and self-awareness, which show moral discipline and professionalism. The study showed that students who engage in martial arts become more confident in handling responsibilities. Similarly, Oliveira & Vieira (2023) stated that practicing martial arts encourages fairness, humility, and ethical awareness through constant training and respect for authority. Together, these studies suggest that martial arts not only improve physical fitness but also strengthen values such as honesty, respect, and responsibility.

Wang (2024) found that martial arts training enhances both physical skills and moral development. Through regular practice, students learn values such as respect, perseverance, and integrity, which strengthen their moral character and ethical decision-making. Wang also highlighted that moral quality grows through discipline and commitment to moral principles, shaping individuals into responsible and well-rounded persons. In addition, martial arts encourage achievement motivation by teaching goal-setting, persistence, and self-improvement. These qualities help in developing leadership, ethics, and work ethic, which are essential for success in life and career.

Zhang (2024) supported these findings by showing that martial arts positively affect students' behavior, focus, and academic performance. He explained that participating in martial arts helps improve discipline, concentration, and goal orientation. These qualities are useful in leadership and decision-making. Tadesse (2024) also stated that martial arts education serves as a pathway for leadership development in higher education by promoting accountability and moral responsibility. Moreover, Fu (2024) emphasized that martial arts cultivate both physical and mental balance, helping students develop calmness, dedication, and proper moral conduct. These findings show that martial arts are not only a sport but also a character-building activity that promotes self-control and respect.

Together, these studies suggest that martial arts not only improve physical fitness but also strengthen values such as honesty, respect, and responsibility. The highest quality of life (in the physical, psychological and environmental domains) was characteristic of the competitors, who practiced only combat sports and martial arts. They also displayed the most health-oriented behaviors. Katarzyna, Leonard, Mirosława, and, Maria (2019). A better understanding of the cultivation of morality in martial arts makes it possible to identify and nurture those moral strategies and practices that make the martial arts a suitable and rich means of moral development and moral education. Martinkova, Parry, & Vágner, (2019).

Furthermore, contemporary martial arts instructors can promote moral development through programs that encourage students to apply moral theory to practical problems using scenario training that confronts them with realistic moral dilemmas (McRae, 2023). In addition, martial arts are associated with more autonomous forms of motivation than combat sports and therefore can foster greater control of aggression and higher ethical sensitivity. K Kostorz, K Sas-Nowosielski (2021). Educators and martial arts organizations should emphasize both technical

training and ethical instruction to foster self-regulation and emotional well-being in adolescents. Moreover, increasing martial arts training intensity may further amplify these benefits. J Parry, M Wagner (2019).

Finally, Bernard Bass's Transformational Leadership Theory (1985) provides a strong foundation for this relationship, suggesting that individuals learn moral and social behavior through observation and imitation. In martial arts, instructors act as role models who show discipline, respect, and integrity. Students learn from observing and practicing these behaviors, which helps them develop moral awareness and emotional control. This process builds leadership, discipline, and a strong sense of responsibility.

Age

Age has been shown to play an important role in influencing students' motivation, persistence, and ethical behavior. According to Ybañez & Barrientos (2023), older students tend to show higher levels of intrinsic motivation and self-efficacy than younger ones because as people grow older, they gain more life experience and maturity. This maturity helps them become more patient, responsible, and capable of setting long-term goals. The study also mentioned that older students are more likely to manage their time wisely and stay focused on their priorities, showing a deeper understanding of what is right and wrong. As individuals age, they develop a stronger sense of responsibility, discipline, and moral awareness. These qualities shape how they make decisions and interact with others. In addition, the development of these traits can be further improved through martial arts training, which teaches endurance, focus, and respect for others. Through consistent practice, individuals not only strengthen their bodies but also their character, learning the value of persistence and humility as they grow older.

Similarly, Demalata et al. (2024) emphasized that age is linked to students' confidence, consistency, and sense of duty in fulfilling academic and personal responsibilities. Their study explained that as students become older, they tend to become more serious about their studies and more consistent in completing their tasks. This maturity allows them to think more critically and act more responsibly, especially when faced with challenging situations. The researchers also highlighted that older students are generally more disciplined and organized, helping them handle stress and pressure in a positive way. As they mature, they also broaden their understanding of ethical behavior and moral values, becoming more aware of the consequences of their actions. This growth contributes to stronger ethical values and greater achievement motivation. In educational settings, this means that older students are often better prepared to make wise decisions and act professionally. In the context of higher education, maturity is very important in shaping an individual's ability to handle stress, make moral choices, and show professionalism—all of which can be further strengthened through martial arts education that promotes patience, self-discipline, and respect.

In support of these findings, Baluga (2020) conducted a study at New Era University and discovered that martial arts programs, such as Arnis, help students develop a greater sense of maturity, self-control, and responsibility. The study showed that older students who participated in martial arts exhibited higher levels of discipline and respect for others, demonstrating how age and experience influence moral growth and leadership behavior. As students mature, they become more capable of understanding the importance of ethical conduct and professional integrity—values that are vital in criminology and law enforcement careers. Similarly, Favorito & Magtibay (2020) found that martial arts education promotes self-reflection and ethical awareness among college students, allowing them to recognize the importance of accountability and teamwork. Their research highlighted that as students grow older, they internalize the moral

lessons learned from martial arts practice, shaping their attitudes toward fairness, responsibility, and respect. These findings further strengthen the idea that age and martial arts experience work together to build character, integrity, and leadership—qualities that are essential for criminology students preparing for their future profession.

Year Level

Year level also plays an important role in shaping students' motivation, discipline, and moral mindset. According to Dela Cruz and Enriquez (2022), students in higher year levels tend to show stronger educational motivation, a deeper sense of responsibility, and more developed moral reasoning than those in lower levels. Their study explained that as students progress through each academic year, they gain more experience and exposure to different learning environments. This experience allows them to develop confidence, self-discipline, and decision-making skills that are useful not only in school but also in their future professional lives. The authors also highlighted that maturity helps students become more aware of ethical standards and moral values, making them more capable of handling responsibilities in academic and real-life situations.

Similarly, Avila and Genio (2020) emphasized that as students advance in their studies, they develop more effective learning strategies and better control over their beliefs and emotions. Their findings suggest that older or higher-level students show a stronger drive to achieve goals and complete tasks efficiently because they understand the importance of

perseverance and effort. The study further noted that higher-year students usually possess higher achievement motivation since they have already experienced various challenges in their academic journey. This allows them to apply their knowledge and adapt to complex situations, especially in fields that require discipline and ethical decision-making, such as criminology.

In the context of criminology education, students in higher levels are more likely to demonstrate leadership readiness, professionalism, and ethical awareness due to their advanced understanding of justice, law, and human behavior. When martial arts training is integrated into their education, this academic maturity further enhances their moral sensitivity, focus, and discipline. Through martial arts, students learn respect, perseverance, and self-control—qualities that strengthen their motivation and work ethics. These traits are essential as they prepare to become future law enforcers or public servants who value integrity, fairness, and service to others.

Gender

Gender also plays an important role in shaping students' levels of motivation, ethical reasoning, and performance behavior. According to Avila and Genio (2020), gender differences influence how students approach learning and self-improvement. Their study revealed that female students tend to demonstrate stronger intrinsic motivation, empathy, and moral sensitivity, showing a natural inclination toward cooperative learning and social awareness. In contrast, male students are often more competitive and achievement-driven, displaying greater persistence when working toward specific goals. The researchers emphasized that these differences highlight how gender shapes students' learning attitudes, emotional control, and motivation to excel, particularly in structured environments such as martial arts training.

In addition, Paggao and Aggabao (2021) found that gender affects both learning strategies and academic performance. Their study explained that female students are more likely to engage in reflective and morally conscious learning behaviors, showing a stronger sense of ethical awareness in group or team-based tasks. Male students, on the other hand, tend to rely on assertiveness, independence, and task-oriented strategies, focusing on achieving high performance outcomes. The authors noted that these distinctions are not about superiority but rather about differences in how each gender interprets and applies discipline, responsibility, and collaboration in academic settings.

Similarly, Demalata et al. (2024) observed that gender influences students' participation, interest, and achievement levels in classroom settings. The study found that female students generally display higher engagement, attentiveness, and moral responsiveness compared to their male counterparts. This can be attributed to their stronger interpersonal awareness and sensitivity to ethical standards. However, male students often excel in demonstrating courage, decisiveness, and self-confidence—qualities that are equally valuable in criminology and martial arts training.

Overall, these findings suggest that gender differences significantly shape how students respond to structured programs like martial arts, influencing the development of moral quality, self-discipline, and achievement motivation. In criminology education, understanding these gendered motivational patterns is essential, as it helps determine how male and female students internalize the moral, disciplinary, and leadership values taught through martial arts practice. These insights are vital for preparing well-rounded criminology students who uphold integrity, fairness, and professionalism in their future law enforcement careers.

Moral Quality

According to Zhichen Wang (2024) in his examine "The Influence of Chinese Martial Arts Teaching on the Moral Quality and Achievement Motivation of College Students in China," martial arts instruction complements not only physical competence but also ethical development. Through regular martial arts training, students develop values of admiration, perseverance, and integrity that improve their moral character and moral decision-making. Wang emphasized that ethical exceptionalism is cultivated through dependent education, area, and adherence to moral norms, which main to the cultivation of a well-rounded and virtuous persona. In this study, ethical exceptionalism is adopted from Wang's framework as one of the key variables, representing the ethical and value-oriented measurement of criminology students' development.

Achievement Motivation

In the same study, Wang (2024) also identified fulfillment motivation as a major psychological outcome of martial arts practice. He explained that the dependent education procedure, rooted in discipline, aim-setting, and endurance, fosters college students’ inner pressure to achieve fulfillment and overcome challenges. Martial arts training builds students’ experience of obligation and effort, which may be crucial components of success motivation. Hence, success motivation is treated as another structured variable in this study, reflecting the students’ dedication, endurance, and commitment toward achieving their educational and professional goals.

In the same have a look at, Wang (2024) also recognized fulfillment motivation as a main psychological outcome of martial arts preparation. He explained that the dependent schooling process, rooted in field, intention-placing, and endurance, fosters students' inner strength to succeed and overcome challenges. Martial arts practice builds students' experience of

responsibility and attempt, which are critical additives of success motivation. Hence, fulfillment motivation is adopted as another established variable in this study, reflecting the scholars' willpower, endurance, and commitment toward achieving their academic and professional goals.

In the Philippines, martial arts, particularly Arnis, have been incorporated into criminology programs as part of physical education and character building. New Era University (2020) discovered that self-defense courses in martial arts significantly improved criminology students' discipline, self-confidence, and ethical awareness. Similarly, Mortejo (2025) found that Arnis training improves teamwork, social responsibility, and moral accountability among students. These results support the idea that martial arts contribute to both moral and motivational development and reflect the goals of criminology education to produce disciplined, ethically guided professionals.

1.3 Conceptual/Theoretical Framework

This study will be anchored by Zhichen Wang's (2024) study titled "The Influence of Chinese Martial Arts Teaching on the Moral Quality and Achievement Motivation of College Students in China," which served as an important basis for the current research. His study showed that teaching Chinese Wushu has a significant impact on students' moral quality (such as honesty, justice, empathy, and patriotism) and motivation to achieve success. The results of his study confirmed that martial arts training is not just a physical activity but a method of moral and character education that teaches discipline, respect, and responsibility.

The current study, titled "Exploring the Impact of Martial Arts and Leadership Discipline, Ethical Mindset, and Work Ethics of Criminology Students in Their Future Profession," is directly related to this because they both aim to explore how martial arts affects the psychosocial behavior, discipline, and ethical Mindset of students. Based on both social and moral theory:

According to Transformational Leadership Theory, students learn behaviors and values such as admiration, discipline, and integrity by observing leaders who set a good example. Martial arts provide a suitable environment for this type of influence because students are constantly guided by their instructors who demonstrate self-control, proper behavior, and inspiring motivation. Meanwhile, Lickona's (1991) Character Education Theory emphasizes that education should cultivate moral values and good character, which are clearly shaped through regular practice and adherence to the principles that are part of martial arts education. When combined, these two theories demonstrate that martial arts not only teach physical skills but also serve as a powerful tool for shaping moral behavior, leadership qualities, and a strong work ethic, which are essential for personal and professional development.

While Zhichen Wang's (2024) study focuses on Chinese students and the coaching of Wushu, the cutting-edge study extends this principle to the Philippine context, specifically among Criminology college students at Saint Michael College of Caraga. In this context, Arnis and other martial arts used Socialization, along with self-esteem, motivation, pressure management, Perspective, and social interaction. Moreover, martial arts education is seen to enhance academic performance overall by improving exam conduct, class participation, and knowledge of motivation. Beyond these academic and behavioral factors, it also aims to reinforce the management skills, ethical mindset, and work ethic essential for students in their future profession as law enforcers. Therefore, Zhichen Wang's (2024) study supports the primary premise of the contemporary studies that martial arts serve as a complete form of individual

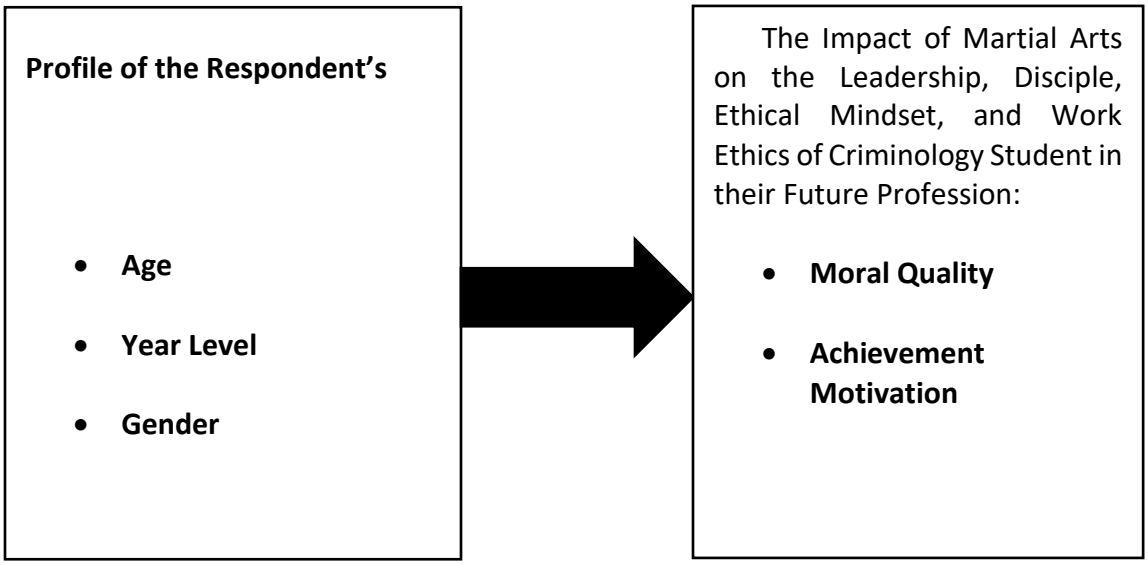
formation, fostering not only physical bodily potential but also morality, self, and moral conduct, which are critical attributes for future professionals within the field of justice and law enforcement.

This study is guided by two theories: the Transformational Leadership Theory (Bass, 1985) and the Character Education Theory (Lickona, 1991). These theories serve as the foundation of the study, connecting martial arts training with the development of leadership, discipline, ethical thinking, and work ethics in criminology students. These are based on recognized psychological and educational frameworks to explain how martial arts affect character development and preparation for professional roles.

These theories show that martial arts can serve as a practical training ground where criminology students develop leadership, discipline, ethical behavior, and professional ethics. Through transformational leadership (Transformational Leadership Theory) and character education (Character Education Theory), martial arts training can positively influence students' behavior and prepare them for their future roles as responsible law enforcers.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

Independent Variables **Dependent Variables**



1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study aims to explore the impact of martial arts training on the leadership discipline, ethical mindset, and work ethics of criminology students in their future profession. Specifically, the study seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of;

    1.1 Age,

    1.2 Year level; and

    1.3 Gender?

2. What is the impact of martial arts on the leadership discipline, ethical mindset, and work ethics of criminology students in their future profession?

    2.1 Moral Quality; and

    2.2 Achievement Motivation?

3. Is there a significant relationship between the demographic profile of the respondents and the Work Ethics of Criminology Students in their Future Profession?

1.6 Hypothesis

H_o – There is no significant relationship between the respondents' profiles and the impact of martial arts on leadership discipline, ethical mindset, and work ethics of criminology students in their future profession.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The following terms and statements are functional and conceptual defined as follows:

Achievement Motivation – it is a person's desire to achieve success, reach goals, and improve one's own abilities.

Age – the number of years lived.

Discipline – it is an individual's ability to control themselves, follow rules, and perform tasks with consistency and responsibility.

Ethical Mindset - it refers to a person's ability and disposition to make the right decision based on moral principles, integrity, and good manners.

Gender – it refers to the identity of an individual as male or female, based on biological and or social aspects.

Leadership - it is the ability of an individual to provide direction, inspiration, and positive influence to others to achieve a goal.

Moral Quality – it refers to a person's level of goodness, honesty, and integrity.

Martial Arts – it is a discipline that focuses not only on physical ability but also on the cultivation of the mind, emotions, and morality.

Work Ethics – it refers to the values, behaviors, and beliefs that demonstrate dedication, responsibility, and professionalism at work.

Year Level – the level of academic standing of a student.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter examines the impact of martial arts on leadership, discipline, ethical mindset, and work ethics of Criminology students in their future profession. It covers research design, setting, respondents, instruments, ethical standards, and data collection methods.

2.1 Research Design

The researchers will use a quantitative, descriptive, correlational study design. This technique provides goal, measurable statistics on the outcomes of martial-arts training in leadership, ethical mindset, and work ethics among criminology students. The researcher may even use a survey-assessment technique with a Likert scale to assess how martial arts training influences students' moral exceptional and fulfillment motivation throughout exceptional year levels. A population sample could be surveyed, and the results will provide information on the criminology student population at Saint Michael College of Caraga. The researchers will use a questionnaire and appropriate sampling procedures to collect data on respondents' perceptions

and experiences with martial-arts training and its effects on their ethical and professional development (Hardwood-Gross et al., 2021).

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The researchers will use a self-made survey questionnaire to be able to be self-made, and proven by means of the research adviser and the studies management. The questions to be used could be self-made that cover the independent and based variables of the research, which provide awareness of the results of martial-arts training on management field, moral attitude, and paintings ethics of criminology students.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study was conducted at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), a Catholic organization located in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

The researchers can have a complete sample of 263 criminology students from the 825 general populace enrolled at some point during the School Year 2024–2025. In which forty-eight are from the first year, 39 from the second 12 months, sixty-five from the third year, and 111 from the fourth year. Random sampling may be used to collect data in line with the study's goals.

Table 1. Respondents of the Study

	POPULATION			SAMPLE					
YEAR LEVEL	Male	Female	Total	Male		Female		Total	
	F	F	F	f	%	f	%	f	%
1ST YEAR	111	41	152	35	13.31	13	4.94	48	18.25
2ND YEAR	85	38	123	27	10.27	12	4.56	39	14.83

3RD YEAR	148	55	203	47	17.87	18	6.84	65	24.71
4TH YEAR	245	102	347	78	29.66	33	12.55	111	42.21
Total	589	236	825	187	71.10	76	28.90	263	100.00

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The following steps will be taken to gather the data:

First, the researchers will draft a consent letter that outlines the purpose of the study and the distribution of the informed consent form. Data will be collected using direct survey forms.

Second, the researchers will present an informed consent form to the participants. This form will serve as an agreement, ensuring that participants understand their rights and are free to either agree to or refuse to answer questions.

Third, Participants will receive a set of validated survey questionnaires and a list of questions prepared by the researchers, which will be answered by each respondent.

Lastly, for the respondents, the researchers will provide a consent form stating the study's purpose, the right to withdraw at any time, and emphasizing that the detailed information

provided will be strictly confidential and accessible only to the researchers. The researchers will apply statistical analysis, treatment, and interpretation when authorized.

Statistical Treatment

The study employed appropriate statistical methods to analyze the collected data. For the demographic profile of respondents (such as age, year level, and gender), frequency and percentage were used. These methods were summarized, and the distribution of respondents was presented, providing a clear and concise representation of the sample's composition. This helped understand the demographic characteristics of the participants.

The study used the means to address the second objective, which involved assessing the impact of martial arts on the leadership, ethical standards, and work ethics of the students. Calculating the mean for each Likert item provided the average score, indicating the overall level of agreement or disagreement among respondents. This helps the researchers determine the students' general perceptions and competency levels related to how martial arts influence their personal and professional development.

The study used a stratified sampling method, dividing the population into strata based on year level (1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th year). This ensured that each subgroup was proportionally represented, thereby enhancing the reliability of the results

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The research study includes original materials that required copyright protection. Specifically, the surveys and questionnaires advanced for records collection were considered

unique intellectual property. This equipment was uniquely designed to align with the research objectives and has not been no longer copied from existing assets. Copyright safety ensured that these substances cannot be used, reproduced, or modified without permission, thereby retaining the integrity and authenticity of the study.

B. Informed Consent

All students of Criminology from first year to fourth year at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) were clearly informed about the purpose, methodology, possible risks, and benefits of the study. Before data collection, written consent was obtained to ensure that their participation was voluntary. Since this study does not involve animals or other living organisms, ethical approval from the institution for animal experiments is not required.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All data collected through structured surveys, including sensitive and private information supplied by participants. To preserve participant privacy, all data will be kept anonymous. Only the researchers will have access to the gathered data, and no information will be shared with outside parties without permission.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

All Criminology students from first year to fourth year at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) have been assured that their participation in the have a look at turned into completely voluntary. They had been knowledgeable of their proper to withdraw at any time with none bad repercussions. Because this studies does not involve animals, ethical considerations regarding their use aren't relevant.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

Steps had been taken to ensure contributors did not experience any bodily, mental, or emotional distress while completing the questionnaires on martial arts education. The risks had

been minimum, as they had a look at the required participants to share their personal answers without any direct approaches or the sharing of private facts. However, to in addition decrease capacity harm, individuals have been assured that there have been no incorrect answers, and their responses would stay anonymous to protect their privacy. The questionnaire was designed to be quick to avoid fatigue, and participants may additionally draw at any time if they feel uncomfortable. Additionally, in the unlikely event that a question prompts emotional soreness, they have been advised to bypass the question or searching for assist from to be had steering services. With these safeguards in place, the take a look at ensured a safe and non-threatening environment for all respondents.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The consequences of this study may be shared with Criminology college students from first year to fourth year at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC). The researchers, as college students, will distribute and present the findings through both face-to-face and online methods. Summaries or reports can be sent by e-mail, published copies, or shared through online platforms. The consequences can also be presented in seminars, workshops, or schooling periods to develop an understanding of martial arts. Additionally, posters and infographics can be displayed in colleges to assist others effortlessly hold close the findings. The take a look at will also be posted in journals, provided at meetings, or posted on social media to reach a wider audience and contribute to the growing knowledge about martial arts and its advantages.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants were chosen based on clearly defined inclusion and exclusion criteria. The selection process was conducted fairly, ensuring that students of Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) from different backgrounds were presented without discrimination. Since this study did not involve animal trials, ethical considerations related to species selection do not apply.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized procedures were implemented to ensure the reliability and consistency of data collection and analysis. Surveys were carefully structured to minimize bias, and any potential errors or limitations were documented to maintain the credibility of the findings.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

All results were provided truthfully, ensuring that no data was misrepresented. Any copyrighted or covered substances referenced within the examine were properly cited and acknowledged to uphold academic integrity. A Conflict of Interest (COI) announcement was included, stating that the researcher had no economic, personal, or professional interests that could have influenced the study's final results. They have a look at changed into the researcher's particular work and free of unauthorized copying or plagiarism. Additionally, AI equipment were used to help in statistical analysis, content creation, and writing enhancement. However, human oversight changed into maintained to make sure accuracy, credibility, and adherence to moral studies requirements.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

This study does not use patented or copyrighted materials. All data collection tools are self-made, properly acknowledged modifications, or from the public domain. Sources are cited and acknowledged where required.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The study concerned human contributors and focused on exploring the effect of martial arts on management, subject, ethical mindset, and work ethics of criminology students in their future profession. Participants have been fully informed about the study's purpose, procedures,

potential risks, and benefits before taking part. Written consent was obtained from all individuals, and parental consent was obtained for minors. All activities were conducted in a secure, controlled environment, ensuring that no participant experienced any damage or discomfort. Confidentiality was strictly maintained, and all accumulated records were used solely for academic and study purposes. Since no animals had been worried, animal-related ethical guidelines were not practice. They observed the institution's ethical requirements and obtained the necessary approvals prior to the records series.

L. Responsible Use of Ai and Other Related Technologies

Tools such as ChatGPT, Google Scholar, ResearchGate, PubMed Central, ERIC, and ProQuest were used to enhance students' learning and research by providing personalized support and efficient access to credible academic resources. This study also used AI-based tools, such as Perplexity AI and Ask AI, to search for related literature and studies relevant to its focus. These platforms helped identify reliable sources, thereby strengthening the researcher's validity. Additionally, writing tools such as Quillbot and Grammarly were used to improve the clarity and overall quality of the text, ensuring the study was presented in a well-structured, professional manner.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

In this study, ethical approval was obtained from the relevant committee of Saint Michael College of Caraga. This approval, documented before the study began to ensure compliance with all ethical guidelines, regulations, and institutional policies.